de Vega and Schaposnik Reply: The arguments given by Kumar and Khare in their Comment seem essentially correct. Actually, a first indication that the energy of the vortex of our Letter[1] is smaller than that of Kumar and Khare[2] (with Chern-Simons term) and de Vega[3] (without Chern-Simons term) simply follows from the following fact. In Ref. 1, one of the two Higgs fields has a coordinate dependence and the other is in its vacuum (constant) state. In the *Ansätze* of Refs. 2 and 3, both Higgs fields depend on coordinates and, hence, large energy is expected. Actually, this was the reason why we choose such a vortex *Ansatz* in Ref. 1. The same arguments can be presumably generalized to the SU(N) vortices of an earlier work of ours.[4]

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Received 1 June 1987
PACS numbers: 11.15.Kc

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